Postpartum Recovery · Vegetarian Fridge Sheet

Evidence-based daily guide · Indian mothers, everywhere · keep on the fridge

EVERY DAY — the 8 things that matter most

- ☐ Protein at every meal — dal, paneer, curd, soy, milk (70–90 g/day) (wound healing + milk)
- ☐ 2–3 dairy servings + one ragi or til item (calcium 1,000–1,200 mg) (bones for two)
- ☐ Iron-rich food + vitamin C at the same meal (lemon on dal; amla/guava) (rebuild blood)
- ☐ 2–3 fruits + vegetables at every meal — all kinds welcome (fibre + vitamins)
- ☐ Whole grains — phulka, dalia, oats, ragi (30 g+ fibre) (prevent constipation)
- ☐ 2.5–3 L fluids — water always within reach at every feed (milk is 87% water)
- ☐ 1 small gond laddoo / panjiri + 30 g nuts & seeds (incl. flax, walnut) (portioned tradition)
- ☐ Walk a little more every day + 15–30 min morning sun (clot + vitamin D defence)

RECOVERY STAGES — what to focus on

Days	Focus	Eat more of	Watch out
Days 1–3	**Eat well from day 1**	Normal home vegetarian food as tolerated; iron + vitamin C; 2.5–3 L fluids	Straining on the toilet; skipping meals
Days 4–7	**Collagen week**	Protein every meal; iron + vitamin C; fibre + fluids + daily walk	Skipping meals; straining on the toilet
Days 8–30	**Nutrient density**	Healing plate: ½ veg + fruit, ¼ protein, ¼ whole grain + dairy	Crash diets; khichdi-only weeks
Days 31–60	**Rebuild stores**	Same plate; algae DHA + B12 per doctor; 6-week checkup	Crunches/sit-ups before clearance
Days 61–90	**Normalise**	Family thali done right; strength work after 12-week clearance	GDM follow-up if advised — don't skip the OGTT

NEVER — no matter what anyone says

- Never fast during recovery — not even until chhathi
- Never restrict water — ajwain water is a choice, plain water is essential
- Never eat paan with supari/tobacco — proven oral-cancer cause (IARC Group 1)
- Never believe food bursts stitches — it mechanically cannot
- No crash dieting while breastfeeding — floor ~1,800 kcal/day

CALL THE DOCTOR NOW — danger signs

- **Fever ≥38°C / 100.4°F**
- **Wound: redness, spreading warmth, discharge or gap**
- **Bleeding that soaks a pad in an hour, or egg-size clots**
- **Chest pain, breathlessness, or severe headache with vision changes**
- **Calf pain or swelling; burning or no urine**
- **Baby feeding poorly or <6 wet diapers/day by day 5**
- **Low mood, hopelessness or intrusive thoughts beyond 2 weeks — helplines below**

Emergency: India 112 / 108 · USA 911 · Canada 911 — Mental-health lines (24/7): India Tele-MANAS 14416 · USA & Canada 988 (call or text)

A NOTE FOR THE FAMILY

She has just given birth while building a baby's entire food supply. What helps: protein at every meal, vegetables and fruits of every kind, water always within reach, sleep in shifts, zero food-fear. What harms: restricting water, banning vegetables and grains, ghee and sweets by default, khichdi-only weeks, paan with supari. Her obstetrician's instructions come before every custom on this sheet.

Educational guide, not a substitute for your obstetrician. Compiled from ICMR-NIN 2020, WHO, ERAS Society, ESPEN, IARC and Cochrane-level evidence. If complications occurred, your doctor's instructions override everything here. Healing Thali — healingthali · 100% vegetarian (no meat, fish or eggs) · Free to share with any family that needs it.